

CURRICULUM VITAE

RUI ZHAO

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATION AND CONTACT INFORMATION

Ph.D. Candidate
Department of Textiles, Apparel Design and Merchandising
College of Agriculture
Louisiana State University
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EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy in Textiles, Apparel Design and Merchandising in Merchandising (In progress) *May 2026*

Louisiana State University (LSU), Baton Rouge, LA

Dissertation topic: "Investigating the Impact of Digital Product Passports on Fashion Consumers' Attitudes and Purchase Intentions"

Committee: Dr. Chuanlan Liu (Chair), Dr. Sibeï Xia, Dr. Bruce Cameron

Master of Fine Arts in Art Design

Guangxi Arts University, Nanning, China

June 2023

Thesis title: "Structural Study and Innovative Design of a Tang Dynasty Short-Sleeved Lined Robe with Standing Collar and Overlapping Front from the Haixi Prefecture Ethnic Museum Collection"

Advisor: Dr. Hongshan Chen

Bachelor of Fine Arts in Dress Design (Knitted Clothes Design)

Beijing City University, Beijing, China

July 2019

Undergraduate thesis title: "The Application of Gender-Blurred Design in Deconstructed Menswear"

Advisor: Dr. Li Yuan

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Centers on digital fashion marketing and innovation, with a focus on enhancing consumer engagement, product transparency, and brand communication through emerging technologies. Ongoing research includes:

1. Integrating Digital Product Passports (DPPs), Digital Twins (DTs), and Artificial Intelligence (AI) for Sustainable Fashion Value Chains: Enhancing Product Development, Traceability, and Consumer Experience;
2. AI-Assisted Design Pedagogies and Educational Frameworks for Creativity, Efficiency, and Sustainability in the Apparel Industry;
3. Digitally Reconstructing Ancient Chinese Dress: Integrating Historical Research, Textile Technology, and Virtual Heritage Methods for Cultural Preservation and Interpretation.

SCHOLARLY PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Articles in Refereed Journals or Bulletins

- Zhao, R.,** Xia, S., & Liu, C. (2026 Manuscript under review). *A Systematic Review on the Use of Artificial Intelligence Technologies in Fashion Education*. Submitted to *Fashion and Textiles*.
- Xia, S., **Zhao, R.,** Liu, C., Zhang, Y., & Ruan, Y. (2026 Manuscript under review). Exploring Generative AI in Jacquard Knitwear Design Education: Insights from Midjourney and ChatGPT. Submitted to *Fashion Practice*.
- Zhao, R.,** & Liu, C. (2025). Consumer Acceptance of Digital Product Passports: The Roles of Technological Awareness and Value Orientations. *Sustainability* ,17(23), 10878.
<https://doi.org/10.3390/su172310878>
- Zhao R.,**Liu C (2026;), "Mapping 3D design system to digital product passport requirements: a case study of CLO3D and Style3D".*Research Journal of Textile and Apparel*, Vol. ahead-of-print No. ahead-of-print.<https://doi.org/10.1108/RJTA-08-2025-0187>
- Zhao, R.,** Liu, D., Guo, Y., & Zhu, B. (2026). A study of colors and auspicious patterns in children's clothing from Yingxi paintings of the Song Dynasty. *Journal of Silk*, 63(2), 113–123.
- Zhao, R.,** & Liu, D. W. (2022). Historical origin and organizational structure of the Aran jumper. (Textile Bioengineering and Informatics Symposium Proceedings, TBIS).

Abstracts of Refereed Papers Published in Proceedings and Symposium Publications

- Xia, S., Liang, J. J., **Zhao, R.,** Liu, C., & Zhang, L. (Accepted). AI integration in professional fashion design software: A case study of CLO3D. *2026 Fashion Symposium*.
- Xia, S., **Zhao, R.,** Liu, C., & Lang, C. (Accepted). Exploring Designer Experiences in Co-Design for Customized Knitwear. *Knit Futures Symposium*.
- Zhao, R.** & Liu, C., (2025) “Optimizing 3D Design Systems for Digital Product Passports and Digital Twins: A Conceptual Framework”,*International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference Proceedings* 1(1). doi: <https://doi.org/10.31274/itaa.21432>
- Zhao, R.** & Liu, C., (2025) “Diffusion of Digital Product Passports: A Focus on Consumer Knowledge and Acceptance”,*International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference Proceedings* 1(1). doi:<https://doi.org/10.31274/itaa.21433>
- Zhao, R.,** Xia, S. & Liu, C., (2025) “Harnessing AI in Fashion Education: A Systematic Literature Review and Future Directions”, *International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference Proceedings* 1(1). doi: <https://doi.org/10.31274/itaa.21434>

- Zhao, R.,** Liu, C., & Lang, C. (2025). "Facilitating fashion digital product passports: A review and comparison of digital twin creation tools", *International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference Proceedings* 81(1). doi: <https://doi.org/10.31274/itaa.18778>
- Zhang, Y., Liu, C., Xia, S. & **Zhao, R.,** (2025) "Themes and Trends in AI-Related Empirical Consumer Studies in Fashion (2022–2025): A Systematic and Bibliometric Review", *International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference Proceedings* 1(1). doi: <https://doi.org/10.31274/itaa.21528>
- Zhang, Y., Liu, C., Xia, S. & **Zhao, R.,** (2025) "Charting Digital Fashion: Categorizing Applications and Navigating Generative AI's Transformative Impact", *International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference Proceedings* 1(1). doi: <https://doi.org/10.31274/itaa.21527>
- Xia, S., **Zhao, R.,** Liu, C., & Zhang, Y. (Accepted for oral presentation). Bridging Generative AI and jacquard knitwear design: classroom exploration and evaluation of using Midjourney and ChatGPT. *International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference*.

Design Exhibition

- Zhao, R.,** Yan, Y., & Liu, C. (Accepted). Reconstructing Song Dynasty Peony Motifs in the Age of AI: A Knit Jacquard Design Transformation. *2026 Fashion Symposium*
- Zhao, R.,** Yan, Y., Xia, S., & Liu, C. (Accepted). Venus Fold: A Knitted Translation of Sculptural Drapery. *Knit Futures Symposium*.
- Zhao, R.,** Zhang, Y., Xia, S. & Liu, C., (2025) "Reimagining the Chiton: Advancing Zero-Waste Knitwear through Historical Inspiration and Digital Innovation", *International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference Proceedings* 1(1). <https://doi.org/10.31274/itaa.21431>
- Xia, S., **Zhao, R.,** Liu, C., & Zhang, Y. (Accepted). The hemp shell: Zero-waste tube-to-wear garment through flatbed knitting. *International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference*.
- Zhao, R.,** Xia, S. & Liu, C., (2025) "Sustainable outdoor gear using knit and woven fabrics: A case of shell jacket", *International Textile and Apparel Association Annual Conference Proceedings* 81(1). <https://doi.org/10.31274/itaa.18779>

Books and Monographs

- Liu, D. (Ed.).** (2023). *Textile Cultural Heritage Literature Integration: Yuan Collection*. Shanghai: Donghua University Press. ISBN 978-7-5669-2347-9.

Other Scholarly Activities

Graduate conference Poster Presentation, Louisiana State University, 2024

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Dissertation Project

**Fall 2025 – Spring
2026**

Dept. of Textiles, Apparel Design and Merchandising, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA

- Simulation Design: Developed non-data-driven Digital Product Passports (DPP) prototypes tailored to different brand types (luxury, premium, mass-market) to construct controlled experimental scenarios.
- Theoretical Framework: Integrated the Multi-Attribute Attitude Model (MAAM) and Theory of Consumer Value (TCV) to analyze consumer perceptions across functional, emotional, and social value dimensions.
- Empirical Analysis: Collected consumer data via online surveys and applied structural equation modeling (SEM) to explore the impact of DPP content on consumer attitude formation and purchase intention.

Course Project

Fall 2025

Dept of Textiles, Apparel Design and Merchandising, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA

- Apply AI in the Retail Buying and Management course.
- Enhance personalized learning, digital literacy, and future career skills.
- Collect student feedback through surveys and interviews to evaluate outcomes.

Course Project

Fall 2025

Dept. of Textiles, Apparel Design and Merchandising, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA

- Integrate AI functions in CLO3D (e.g., auto-pattern generation, AI-assisted fitting, fabric simulation) into classroom teaching.
- Enhance students' personalized design experience, digital literacy, and engagement through CLO3D's AI-driven features.
- Collect student feedback via surveys and interviews to evaluate the effectiveness of AI-assisted CLO3D learning.

Course Project

Spring 2025

Dept. of Textiles, Apparel Design and Merchandising, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA

- Integrate AI and generative tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Midjourney) into classroom teaching.
- Enhance personalized learning, digital literacy, and student engagement.
- Collect student feedback through surveys and interviews to evaluate outcomes.

Research Assistantship

Spring 2025

Dept. of Textiles, Apparel Design and Merchandising, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA

- Assisted in exploring potential dissertation research directions.

- Conducted literature collection and review to support dissertation topic development.

Thesis Project

Spring 2023

Dept. of Apparel and Accessory Design, Guangxi Arts University, Guangxi, China

- Analyzed the structure, fabric layout, garment–body relationship, and historical background of a Tang Dynasty round-collar robe from the Hai Xizhou Minzu Museum, Qinghai.
- Developed innovative design concepts informed by the garment's form and cultural context.

National Research Project China

Fall 2023

Premier's Fund of the State Council, Textile and Laboratory Archaeology, Institute of Archaeology, Chinese Academy of Social Sciences, Beijing, China (2019–2023) (KG001A)

- Participated in a national key laboratory development and research platform project.
- Responsible for textile artifact conservation, laboratory archaeology documentation, and database development.
- Supported 40+ archaeological and conservation projects, co-authored publications, and monographs.

Funded Research Projects in China

Fall 2021

Innovation Project, Institute of Archaeology, Chinese Academy of Social Sciences, Beijing, China (2021)

- Research on Field Extraction and Laboratory Cleaning and Conservation of Ancient Fabrics Unearthed in Northwest China (2021KGYG023)
- Contributed to sub-research focusing on laboratory cleaning and conservation of excavated textiles.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, TAM 3042 Apparel Merchandise Buying and Management

Spring 2026

Dept. of Textiles, Apparel Design and Merchandising, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA

- Supported the instructor in course delivery and classroom activities.
- Assisted students with course assignments and merchandise planning projects.
- Contributed to grading and provided feedback to support student learning.

Teaching Assistant, TAM 4070 Fashion Entrepreneurship

Spring 2026

Dept. of Textiles, Apparel Design and Merchandising, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA

- Supported the instructor in course delivery and classroom activities.
- Assisted students with course assignments and projects.
- Contributed to grading and provided feedback to support student learning.

Instructor, TAM 3042 Retail Buying and Management

Fall 2025

Dept. of Textiles, Apparel Design and Merchandising, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA

- Concepts and theories in retailing, consumer behavior, apparel buying, and management; role and responsibilities of merchandise buyers; domestic and foreign merchandise resources and negotiation.
- Teaching students how to use AI for research and writing improvement.

Teaching Assistant, TAM 3430 Emerging Technology

Fall 2025

Dept. of Textiles, Apparel Design and Merchandising, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA

- Assist students in preparing their work for critiques and showcases.
- Support the instructor in providing course-related guidance.
- Teach students how to use the AI features in CLO3D to assist with their designs.

Teaching Assistant, TAM 1232 Digital Illustration for Apparel Designers

Spring 2025

Dept. of Textiles, Apparel Design and Merchandising, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA

- Assist students in preparing their work for critiques and showcases.
- Support the instructor with course-related guidance.
- Teach students how to use the AI features in Adobe Photoshop to assist with design.

Teaching Assistant, TAM 4046 Merchandising Mathematics

Spring 2025

Dept. of Textiles, Apparel Design and Merchandising, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA

- Assist students in completing course assignments and lab sections.
- Support the instructor with course-related guidance and grading assignments.

Teaching Assistant, TAM 3430 Emerging Technology / 7030 Creativity in Design

Fall 2024

Dept. of Textiles, Apparel Design and Merchandising, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA

- Assist students in preparing their work for critiques and showcases.
- Support the instructor with course-related guidance.

- Teach students how to use Midjourney to assist with design.

Teaching Assistant, TAM 4046 Merchandising Mathematics	<i>Spring 2024</i>
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Dept. of Textiles, Apparel Design and Merchandising, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA

- Assist students in completing course assignments and lab sections.
- Support the instructor with course-related guidance and grading assignments.

Instructor, Fundamentals of Draping	<i>Fall 2020</i>
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Dept. of Apparel and Accessory Design, Guangxi Arts University, Guangxi, China

- Demonstrate an understanding of the fundamental principles and methods of draping.
- Analyze Western and Chinese costume history and identify differences in pattern making.

WORKING EXPERIENCE

Intern, China Knitted Apparel Design and Research Center	<i>Summer 2015</i>
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- Conducted research on fashion trend forecasting.
- Assisted in fabric structure development.

Intern, Textile Cultural Relics Committee of the China Cultural Relics Society	<i>Spring 2018</i>
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- Organized data on textiles excavated from ancient tombs.
- Produced drawings of ancient textile patterns.

SERVICES

Registration Desk, St. Louis, Missouri, 2026. International Textiles and Apparel Association (ITAA)

PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATIONS

Member of the International Textile and Apparel Association (ITAA) since 2023.

FUNDING

Conference Travel Grant	<i>Fall 2025</i>
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Dept. of Textiles, Apparel Design and Merchandising, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA

- Up to \$600 to support travel to conferences

Conference Travel Grant	<i>Fall 2024</i>
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*Dept. of Textiles, Apparel Design and Merchandising, Louisiana State University,
Baton Rouge, LA*

- Up to \$400 to support travel to conferences

HONORS AND AWARDS

Finalist of the 25th " <i>China International Leather and Fur Fashion Design Competition</i> ", <i>China</i>	2023
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Excellent Rendering Award of the 24th " <i>China International Leather and Fur Fashion Design Competition</i> ", <i>China</i>	2022
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Excellent Award of 2021 " <i>Charming Oriental Underwear Design Competition</i> " <i>China</i>	2021
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TECHNICAL SKILLS

Computer-aided design programs:

- Adobe Illustrator
- Adobe Photoshop
- Shima Seiki programs
- CLO3D
- Style3D
- Midjourney
- Procreate

Machines:

- Industrial sewing machines
- Industrial overlock sewing machines

Other:

- SPSS, SPSS AMOS, NVivo, VOSviewer, Biblioshiny (R Studio)
- Microsoft Office
- Cursor

LANGUAGES

Chinese: Native

English: Professional working proficiency